

1 May 1960

THE U-2 INCIDENT

An American U-2 spyplane piloted by Gary Powers was shot down deep inside the Soviet Union by a Russian surface-to-air missile. Previous successful missions had made US authorities confident that the high altitude at which the U-2s flew put them outside enemy range. Powers survived and was taken prisoner. The incident increased Cold War tensions and helped derail a four-power summit held in Paris a fortnight later.

▷ Gary Powers, U2 pilot



1960

8 November 1960
John F. Kennedy is elected 35th President of the US

5 July 1962 **Algeria wins independence** from France after a bitter eight-year war



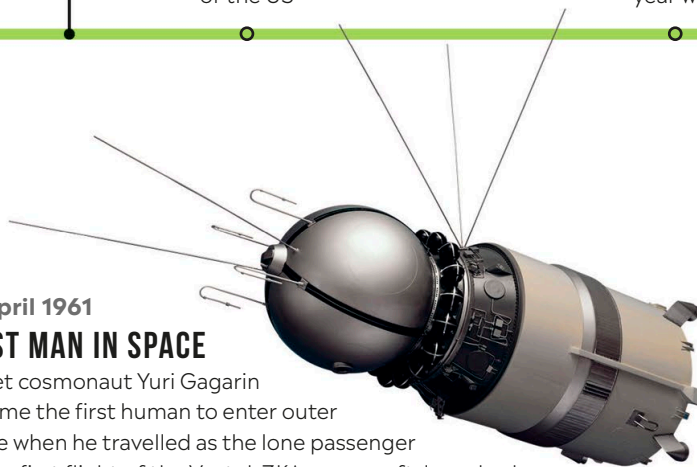
1917-63
JOHN F. KENNEDY

As the youngest candidate elected to the US presidency, Kennedy brought charm and good looks to the office. The hopes raised by his tenure were brutally dashed by his assassination.

12 April 1961

FIRST MAN IN SPACE

Soviet cosmonaut Yuri Gagarin became the first human to enter outer space when he travelled as the lone passenger on the first flight of the Vostok 3KA spacecraft, launched from the Baikonur Cosmodrome in southern Kazakhstan. The capsule he flew in completed one full orbit of the Earth after separating from its booster rockets. As it fell back to Earth, Gagarin ejected and landed successfully by parachute. The event was seen as another triumph for the ongoing Soviet space programme.



△ Vostok capsule

“I see Earth! It is so beautiful!”

YURI GAGARIN, ON THE VIEW FROM THE VOSTOK CRAFT, 1961